

SEDAR 70 Gulf of Mexico Greater Amberjack

Recommendations for considerations of future research are provided below and do not indicate any particular order of priority.

Life History

- Develop improved estimates of maturity ogives and develop fecundity estimates for use model work

Landings and Discards

- Expand commercial fishery observer coverage and in particular focus on better quantifying retained fish out of season
- Increase sampling of length and age composition data from both commercial and recreational landings in particular for discarded fish
- Quantify and evaluate appropriate weighting procedures of length and age compositions at finer spatial and temporal scales (e.g., quarterly/state/sub-region strata)
- Characterize imputations in MRIP statistics at finer level (e.g., identify round of imputation)

Fishery Independent Indices

- SEAMAP Ichthyoplankton Surveys:

At this time, no larval abundance index for Greater Amberjack is available. *Seriola* spp. larvae are taken in both bongo and neuston nets during SEAMAP surveys. At the time of the SEDAR 33 assessment, there are at least 3,500 specimens initially identified as *Seriola* spp., however these specimens will have to be re-examined to verify identification. This task should be accomplished prior to next Benchmark/research track.

Fishery Dependent Indices

- Investigate options for developing fishery-dependent surveys that better reflecting abundance of Greater Amberjack from dependent fisheries with particular focus on impact on index development from other fishery regulatory measures
- Investigate appropriateness of use of design-based estimator for Coastal Logbook Program given that a survey design is not in use for the fisher reported logbook data